

The Manual Way- for the super geeks

Instead of using the kitchen, you can also create the working folder manually. Create a new folder with the nomenclature **WORKING_rom** name. The working folder should have 3 files/ folders- **meta-inf**, **system** and **boot.img**. You can source the **meta-inf** folder from the free web. Ensure that you find one compatible with your device. You can usually just extract it from the device's stock ROM. This is the directory which TWRP or any other recovery software looks for when you intend to flash anything. So it's an absolute must. Similarly important is the **boot.img** file. You will get that also from the stock ROM. Alternatively, you can also download any custom kernel which is only for your device and extract it with WinRAR or 7-Zip and copy **boot.img** to Working folder.

There are 2 ways to get the system folder if it's not present in the stock ROM – using the **ftf_extractor** folder and from the phone.

Open the file inside the **ftf_extractor** folder with 7-Zip. Select the file named **system** and extract it. Open command prompt inside the **ftf_extractor** folder and type *aIUP.exe system.sin 2048 <folder name>* (where the files are to be extracted e.g. **system**). This is the best way to get the system folder.

Alternatively, to get the system folder from your rooted phone, download Terminal Emulator from Google Play. You will also need SuperUser (SU) or Magisk. Open Terminal Emulator and type in

- `su`
- `tar -c system/* >> sdcard/system.tar`

This will copy all your **/system** folder to your SDcard with name **System.tar**. Extract this file using 7-Zip. If you see folders titled **lost-found** and **sd**, delete them and copy the system folder to the **WORKING** folder. Let's take a look at the files and folders within the system folder-

- **app** folder, as the name suggests, contains various apps and services which will run on your ROM. If you navigate to this app folder, you will see another a huge list of subfolders. These subfolders contains apks for the apps.
- **cameradata** folder contains various files which are essential for the camera to work.
- **csc** folder is a folder which would be gem for modders. Most of the mods that you want in the ROM could be just be added with a single line, by modifying a file or two in this folder.
- **fonts** contains the various fonts which will be used in the ROM.